Buddy puppets

PreK-Grade 3 with support | 15-25 minutes | Four animal choices

Gather

Paper or light card, crayons, child-sized scissors, and tape or glue. Folded paper strips make handles; no craft sticks are required.

Make together

1. Choose a buddy on pages 2-3. Color and name it.
2. Cut only around the thick rounded border.
3. Cut a handle on page 4, fold it lengthwise, and tape it to the back of the card. Leave a little handle below the card.
4. Add a speech card or tell the story in your own way.

Ways to join in

An adult stays nearby for scissors and assembly. Offer left- or right-handed scissors as appropriate. A child may point, draw, use AAC, direct a partner, or ask for help. For a no-cut version, leave the page whole and point to the pictures.

Practice with your hands

Coloring, cutting around broad curves, folding, holding paper steady, and placing tape. Try one step at a time or share the steps with a partner.

Tell a story

Two buddies want the same art tool. What does each buddy want? How could they ask for a turn? Try switching roles. Your characters can use words or routines from your family.

Connect to the website

Use with Buddy Studio or Practice Together: One tool, two ideas. The printed characters are original templates; decorate them to resemble your digital buddy.

Print on US Letter paper at 100% / Actual size. Black-and-white copies work well. You may print, copy, and adapt these original pages for your home or classroom. Skill practice is flexible; these pages are not an assessment or therapy program.

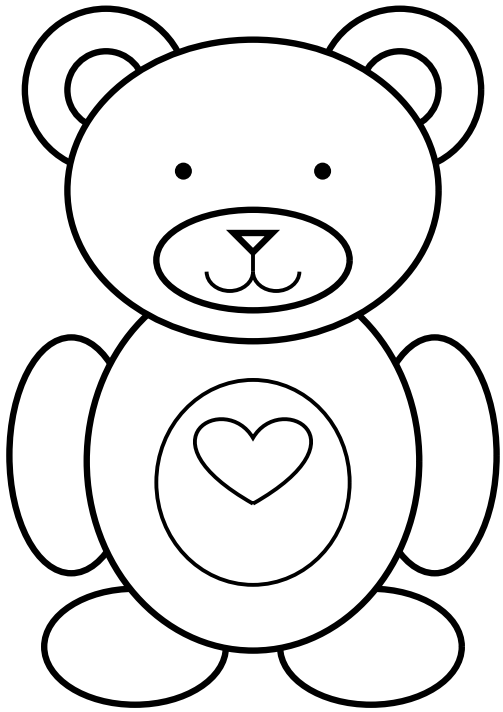
Choose your buddy

Color the inside. Cut only around each thick rounded border.

CUT thick outside borders

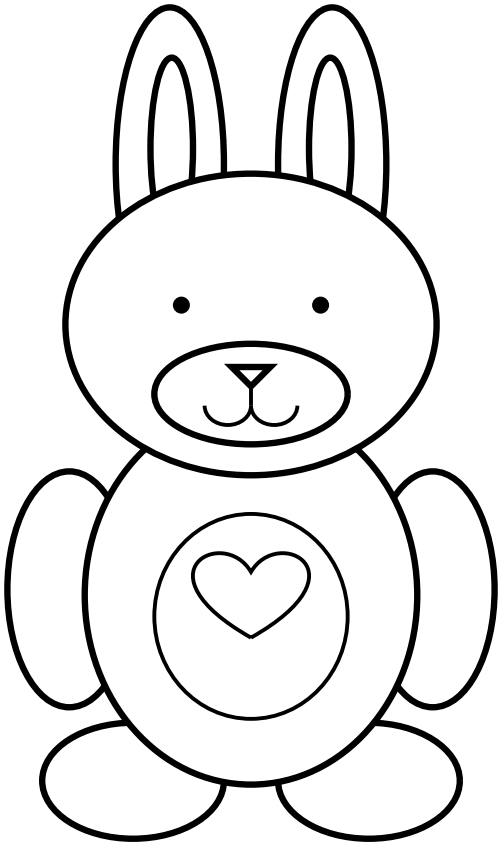
Thin lines are for coloring.

Bear



My name is _____

Bunny



My name is _____

You can also keep these as whole-page pictures. Point, draw, or move a finger to show what your buddy does.

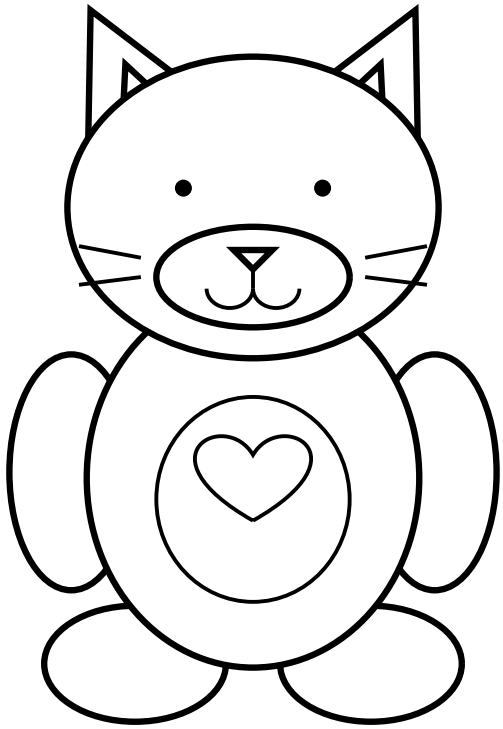
Choose your buddy

Color the inside. Cut only around each thick rounded border.

CUT thick outside borders

Thin lines are for coloring.

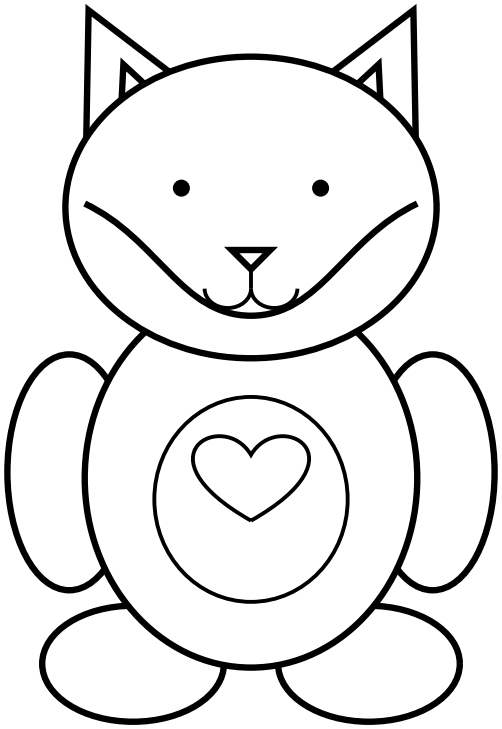
Cat



My name is

_____

Fox



My name is

_____

You can also keep these as whole-page pictures. Point, draw, or move a finger to show what your buddy does.

Words and paper handles

Use your own words, a drawing, symbols, or a gesture.

CUT thick outside borders

FOLD dashed lines

I would like...

_____

_____

_____

Could we try...

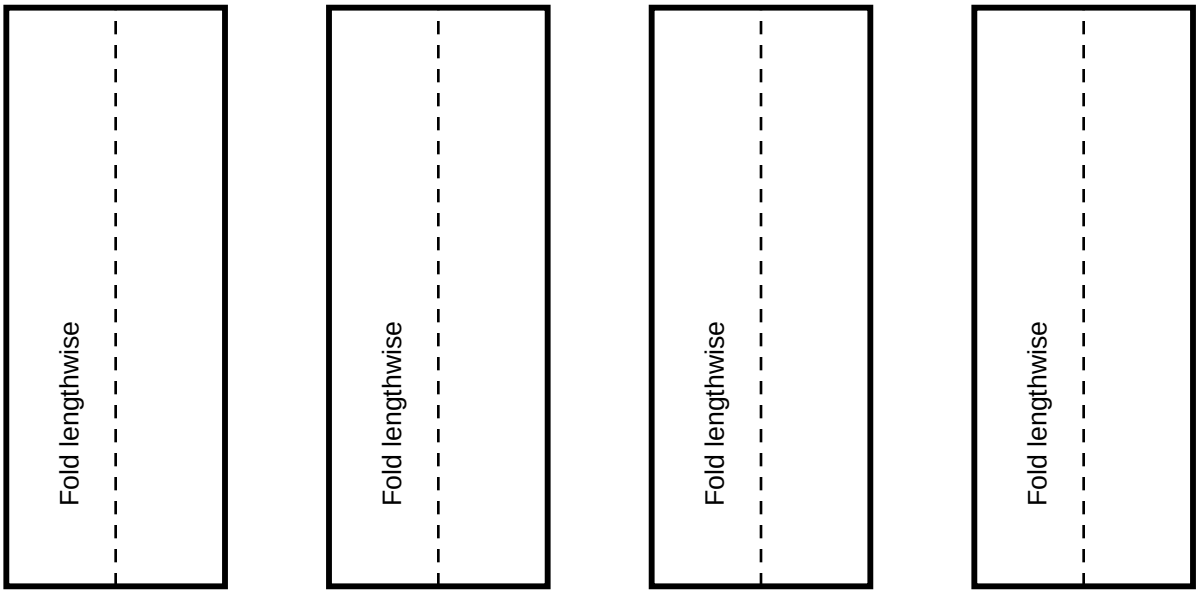
_____

_____

_____

Folded paper handles

Cut a strip. Fold on its dashed line. Tape the upper part to the back of your puppet card.



No handle? Use the card flat on the table, lean it against a block, or let a partner hold it.